

0.0.1 For the Welfare of Many

1. This indeed was said by the Auspicious One, said by the Arahant, as heard by me:

2. These three individuals, O bhikkhus, arising in the world, arise for the welfare of many, for the happiness of many, out of compassion for the world, for the good, welfare and happiness of devas and humans. Which three?

3. Here, O bhikkhus, the Tathagata, the Arahant, the rightly self-awakened one, excelling in knowledge and conduct, well-farer, knower of worlds, incomparable trainer of persons to be tamed, teacher of devas and humans, awakened, auspicious. He teaches the Dhamma that is auspicious in the beginning, auspicious in the middle, auspicious in the end, with the right meaning and phrasing, making known the life of purity that is utterly perfect and pure. This, O bhikkhus, is the first individual arising in the world who arises for the welfare of many, for the happiness of many, out of compassion for the world, for the good, welfare and happiness of devas and humans.

4. Furthermore, O bhikkhus, there is also that Teacher's disciple who is an arahant with asavas extincted, one who has lived [the life of purity], done what must be done, laid down the burden, attained the true advantage,

completely extincted the fetters of being, one who is liberated by right final knowledge. He teaches the Dhamma that is auspicious in the beginning, auspicious in the middle, auspicious in the end, with the right meaning and phrasing, making known the life of purity that is utterly perfect and pure. This, O bhikkhus, is the second individual arising in the world who arises for the welfare of many, for the happiness of many, out of compassion for the world, for the good, welfare and happiness of devas and humans.

5. Furthermore, O bhikkhus, there is also that Teacher's disciple, a sekha, following the way, one of much learning, accomplished in virtue. He teaches the Dhamma that is auspicious in the beginning, auspicious in the middle, auspicious in the end, with the right meaning and phrasing, making known the life of purity that is utterly perfect and pure. This, O bhikkhus, is the third individual arising in the world who arises for the welfare of many, for the happiness of many, out of compassion for the world, for the good, welfare and happiness of devas and humans.

6. This is the meaning of what the Auspicious One said. Thus, this was said there:

1. "Indeed the Teacher, the great sage, is first
in the world,
then there is his disciple, one attained to self-

composure;
 then another too is the sekha, following the
 way,
 one of great learning, accomplished in virtue.

2. These three are the foremost among devas
 and humans,
 luminaries, they cause the Dhamma to appear;

they open the door to the deathless,
 causing to free many people from bondage.

3. Those who follow the path,
 well taught by the unsurpassed caravan leader;

only they will make an end of suffering in this
 world,
 those who are vigilant in the Well-farer's in-
 structions."

7. "This too is the meaning of what was said by the
 Auspicious One. Thus was heard by me".